

VANDANA THAKUR

Customer Service Representative | Client Relations | Financial Services

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<https://www.linkedin.com/in/vandana-thakur-62783324/> | Open Work Permit – Valid until September 2028

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Client-focused professional with 10+ years of experience in customer engagement, relationship management, team leadership and financial services. Proven ability to listen actively, understand client needs, resolve issues with accountability and connect clients to the right solutions. Passionate about people, technology-savvy, and committed to delivering meaningful client experiences. Brings deep knowledge of financial services products including insurance, banking concepts, credit, and payments. Fully authorized to work in Canada. Bilingual in English and Hindi — able to serve Toronto's diverse communities effectively.

CORE SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

Client Relations & Engagement | Customer Service Excellence | Financial Services Knowledge
Online Banking & Digital Literacy | Mobile Banking Applications | Technology Adoption
Problem Solving & Accountability | Active Listening | Client Issue Resolution
Goal Oriented | Teamwork & Collaboration | Trust & Integrity
Credit Cards | Payments | Banking Products | Financial Processing | Insurance
Flexible Availability — Evenings & Weekends | Multi-location Adaptability

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder & Client Services Trainer

Dec 2022 – Mar 2025

Durga Consultancy | Independent Client-Facing Professional Services Practice

- Delivered one-on-one personalized client sessions — actively listened to each client's needs, assessed their challenges and provided tailored solutions
- Managed complete client lifecycle — scheduling, engagement, follow-up and continuous improvement based on client feedback
- Built strong client relationships based on trust, accountability and consistent quality of service
- Leveraged digital tools and technology to manage client communications and service delivery efficiently

Cluster Manager / Branch Manager

Dec 2019 – Oct 2022

Reliance General Insurance | One of India's top 5 General Insurers | Financial Services | 20M+ Customers

- Managed client-facing operations across multiple branches — ensured every client interaction was handled with professionalism and care
- Resolved complex client issues with accountability — knew when to handle personally and when to connect clients to the right team member
- Introduced digital tools and mobile platforms to improve client experience and operational efficiency
- Led, trained and motivated a team of 30+ to consistently deliver outstanding client service and meet goals
- Ensured compliance with financial services regulations and company policies at all times

Branch Head (Office In-Charge)

Jan 2015 – Nov 2019

Bajaj Allianz General Insurance | *Leading Private General Insurer | Joint Venture with Allianz SE, Germany | Financial Services*

- Established a full-service client-facing branch from scratch — built trusted relationships with clients from diverse backgrounds
- Launched community financial literacy programs — helped clients understand banking and insurance products to make informed financial decisions
- Trained team of 30+ agents on client engagement, product knowledge, and delivering meaningful client experience
- Maintained high client satisfaction through proactive issue resolution and consistent follow-through

Sales Manager

Aug 2014 – Jan 2015

Reliance General Insurance | *One of India's top 5 General Insurers | Financial Services*

- Managed client relationships and engagement strategies to improve service quality and retention
- Connected clients to appropriate financial products and team members based on their specific needs

Agency Manager

Jan 2012 – Jul 2014

Max Bupa Health Insurance | *Leading Health Insurance Provider | Financial Services | Backed by Bupa UK*

- Engaged directly with clients to understand their health insurance needs and match them to appropriate products
- Trained 60+ team members on client engagement, needs-based conversations and delivering exceptional service
- Conducted regular performance check-ins, provided coaching and maintained high service standards

Associate Professor – HR & Marketing

Oct 2008 – Jul 2009

ASM Group of Institutes | *Reputed Management Institute | MBA and PGDM Programs*

- Engaged daily with diverse students — adapted communication style to different learning needs and backgrounds
- Mentored students on professional development and career readiness — passionate about people growth

Business Development Manager

Jul 2006 – Sep 2008

Bajaj Allianz Life Insurance | *Leading Private Life Insurer | Financial Services | Joint Venture with Allianz SE, Germany*

- Managed client-facing responsibilities in life insurance — built relationships based on trust, empathy and financial knowledge
- Ranked among top national performers for client engagement and premium collections

Scientific Business Officer

Mar 2005 – Jul 2006

Dr. Reddy's Laboratories | *Multinational Pharmaceutical Company | Listed on NYSE*

- Engaged healthcare professionals with product knowledge and built strong territory relationships through consistent, reliable service

EDUCATION

Post Graduate Diploma in Business Management (HR & Marketing)

ISM Ranchi | 2003–2005

Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.)

St. Xavier's College, Ranchi

CERTIFICATIONS & DEVELOPMENT

- Licentiate Certification — Insurance Institute of India | Life, Health & General Insurance | Financial Services Knowledge
- Data Science & Machine Learning — Scaler Academy (In Progress) | Digital Literacy & Analytics

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Work Authorization: Open Work Permit — Valid until September 2028 | Authorized to work for any Canadian employer

Availability: Flexible — Full-time | Evenings | Weekends | Multiple Banking Centre Locations

Languages: English (Professional) | Hindi (Native) — serves Toronto's diverse South Asian community

References: Available upon request